

editing but animation and compositing as well which is a heavy burden to take on. The application does have its proponents with companies like Intel, Nvidia and HP giving sponsorship towards its development. The currently available version is as polished it gets with minor bugs. The program has a fairly challenging learning curve with a slightly new orientation of elements. The editing layout is in three key modules for editing, compositing and animation all of which are fed from a single Bin of media libraries. The program requires an OpenGL GPU architecture to handle most of its tasks and gives great results with speed and quality. The application is at par in terms of flexibility and versatility in comparison to professional tools with integrated effects and audio editing features. It supports a wildly imaginative variety of effects and even allows developer level users to tweak and add their own effects using the SDK. The application also supports a very wide variety of file formats including RAW DV, AVI, QuickTime, Mpeg, MP3, WAV and Ogg and can export files in DivX, RAW DV and other Mpeg based formats. But it should be noted that it isn't purely a entry-level editing program due to its complexity and is best suited for intermediate or advanced users.

Zwei-Stein or ZS4

Get it at: <http://www.zs4.net>

Run it on: Linux or Windows

At first glance ZS4 may seem like the last software you would like to work on but rest assured it's on this list for a reason. Almost all other free to use video editing software's we've discussed try their best to provide the best user interface and intuitive layout as a means to make things easier. In contrast ZS4 is built with user experience as a secondary priority and features at the forefront. As a replacement for any professional level editing tool ZS4 performs superbly, once you get the hang of it. The editing app allows a truly non-linear non-destructive editing interface with an immense detailing of features and plug-in compatibility. The application allows up to 256 separate audio and video clips to be worked on with numerous filters, transitions, effects, VFX controls, colour grading and so much more. Any serious filmmaker would find their needs met by this software. The downside of its hard to learn interface can best be solved through online tutorials that people have shared on YouTube, which once digested can make the experience far less painful. The program rewards effort and have save you thousands in investment but clearly it isn't for a beginner who will most definitely